

least for a few months. You won't be tempted to check your email or Facebook feed every five minutes, and you'll save a bundle too.

4. CUT BACK WHERE YOU CAN

If having a smartphone is a non-negotiable, there are still a surprising number of ways to save on your cell phone plan if you're diligent about how much you actually use it. While unlimited talk, texting, and data sounds like a dream, it's also quite expensive. Look over your bill to see how much you're being charged for each of those items, and downgrade your plan for a lower rate.

This means you need to be conscious about staying under a certain minute or data package, which sounds hard at first, but you can actually save a lot of bandwidth just by surfing the internet and downloading apps on your own Wi-Fi network.

Also be aware of what apps are hogging the most data. This will mostly be in the videos you watch, pictures you upload, and any live streaming apps you use during the day, but you can also check the My Data Manager app to be absolutely sure. For texting, you can also use a free texting app, such as Text Me, to help stay under the allotted amount.

Regarding insurance, it's hard to say whether an extra monthly payment on your phone is actually worth it, especially since it's often accompanied with a \$200 deductible. Since I have experience with a husband who has a habit of ruining phones, I tend to err on the side of caution, but you don't always have to pay for insurance through your specific carrier. [SquareTrade.com](https://www.squaretrade.com) offers a phone protection plan for less than \$5/month, and only requires a \$75 deductible if something breaks on your phone, or it dies completely.

READER TIP:

I recently became a SAHM, so we reduced our data plan from "unlimited" to 1GB per month. This alone is saving us \$40/month! We don't need the same amount of data anymore since I'm home all day and can tap into our home Wi-Fi.